Microsoft 365

Administrative Guide for System Administrators

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> **Microsoft 365 is a cloud-based productivity suite** that combines Office applications, enterprise services, and device management into a comprehensive platform requiring centralized administration and security management.

What is Microsoft 365?

Microsoft 365 is a subscription-based service that integrates Office applications (Word, Excel, PowerPoint), cloud services (Exchange Online, SharePoint, Teams), and enterprise management tools. As a sysadmin, you manage user access, security policies, compliance, and service configurations across the entire organization.

Core Services You'll Manage

Exchange Online Email, calendars, contacts	**SharePoint Online** Document management, intranets	**Microsoft Teams** Chat, meetings, collaboration
OneDrive Personal cloud storage	**Azure AD** Identity and access management	**Intune** Device management
Power Platform Custom apps and automation	**Security Center** Threat protection	**Compliance Center** Data governance

Key Administrative Tasks

User & License Management

- Create and manage user accounts
- Assign and revoke licenses
- Configure user properties and settings
- Manage groups and distribution lists
- Handle password resets and account lockouts

Security & Compliance

- Configure multi-factor authentication
- Set up conditional access policies
- Monitor security alerts and reports
- Manage data loss prevention policies
- Configure retention and archiving

Service Configuration

- Configure Exchange mail flow and policies
- Set up SharePoint sites and permissions
- Manage Teams policies and settings
- Configure mobile device policies
- Set up external sharing controls

Monitoring & Reporting

- Monitor service health and outages
- Review usage analytics and reports
- Track license utilization
- Analyze security and compliance reports
- Monitor mailbox storage and limits

Primary Admin Portals

Essential Administrative Interfaces:

- **Microsoft 365 Admin Center:** Central hub for user, license, and service management
- **Exchange Admin Center:** Email and mailbox configuration
- **SharePoint Admin Center:** Site and content management
- **Teams Admin Center:** Teams policies and settings
- **Azure AD Portal:** Identity and access management
- **Security & Compliance Center:** Threat protection and governance

Common License Types

Microsoft 365 Business Basic

Target: Small businesses, web-only

- Web versions of Office apps
- Exchange, SharePoint, Teams
- 1TB OneDrive storage

Microsoft 365 Business Standard

Target: Small/medium business

- Desktop Office applications
- All Business Basic features
- Outlook, Publisher, Access

Microsoft 365 E3

Target: Enterprise users

- Advanced security features
- Compliance tools
- Advanced analytics
- Rights management

Microsoft 365 E5

Target: Enterprise premium

- All E3 features plus
- Advanced threat protection
- Phone system capabilities
- Advanced compliance

> **Bottom Line:** Microsoft 365 administration involves managing a complex ecosystem of cloud services. Focus on identity management, security policies, and service configuration while leveraging both GUI portals and PowerShell for efficient administration.

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